David Lafond

Product Designer

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) Aug 2024 - Jan 2026
Master of Architecture, School of Architecture & Planning; Certificate in Product Management; GPA: 4.8/5.0 Cambridge, MA

McGill University Aug 2020 - May 2023
B.Sc. in Architecture, Faculty of Engineering; Computational Design Lab Founding Member; GPA: 3.94/4.00 Montreal, QC

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Architect Mar 2026 - Sep 2026
Tekuma Urban Innovation

- Directed creative strategy and client presentations across four urban megaprojects in China, the Middle East, and Africa.
- Translated client requirements into pitch decks, 3D visualizations, and animated films for Jumeirah Central, a $20B Dubai development.
- Established an AI-enabled production system for rapid prototyping, cutting turnaround from early concept to final render by more than 50%.

Product Designer & UX Researcher Apr 2025 - Sep 2025
MIT Media Lab, Fluid Interfaces

- Built four prototypes with engineers for a 0-to-1 AI-assisted productivity & wellness app on desktop and iOS/Android (React Native/Expo).
- Translated technical constraints and therapist feedback into product decisions while facilitating alignment across research and engineering.
- Synthesized findings from 20 user interviews conducted during a 2-week field study into prioritized improvements to the product experience.

Entrepreneur in Residence Jan 2025 - Apr 2025
Martin Trust Center for MIT Entrepreneurship

- Designed and shipped an NFC-enabled cross-platform B2B SaaS product for textile traceability, material evaluation, and apparel development.
- Built three iterative prototypes that validated core workflows and defined the MVP scope for sample-to-production documentation.
- Conducted 23 customer discovery interviews with textile and apparel industry stakeholders to map product requirements and feature priorities.

Product Designer Jan 2025 - Feb 2025
Pumba Parking

- Owned product discovery and strategy for a Tel Aviv smart-parking startup expanding its B2C mobile app into B2G software for U.S. cities.
- Converted insights from 12 industry interviews into desktop workflows, high-fidelity mockups, and interactive dashboard prototypes.
- Iterated dashboard flows through weekly remote one-on-ones with the CEO, defining the MVP scope for the U.S. municipal market.

Research Assistant, Data Visualization Sep 2024 - Jan 2025
MIT Senseable City Lab

- Shipped a 0-to-1 interactive web experience making complex computer-vision research understandable to a broad public audience.
- Produced 10+ iterative prototypes through weekly design reviews, refining information architecture, visualization, and interaction design.
- Built three GeoGuessr-inspired mobile prototypes after interest from The New York Times, translating research into interactive gameplay.

INDEPENDENT EXPERIENCE

Content Creator & Community Builder Mar 2025 - Present
David's Journal

- Built an educational YouTube channel on design, technology, and philosophy, reaching 10K+ subscribers and 35K+ monthly viewers in 12 months.
- Produced 38 long-form videos that generated 340K+ views and 4M impressions, attracting sponsorships from LG Electronics and Kimi AI.
- Expanded the channel into an 800+ member design community and earned $6K+ in revenue through paid workshops within its first six months.

SKILLS

Design: Information Architecture, UX/UI, Motion Design, Accessibility, Storytelling, Prototyping, Design Systems, AI Workflows
Research: User Interviews, Surveys, Usability Testing, Qualitative & Quantitative Research, Conjoint Analysis, MAXQDA, Sawtooth
Collaboration: Design Strategy, Adaptability, Cross-functional Collaboration, Feedback Incorporation, Service Blueprinting
Tools: Codex, Claude Code, Git, React Native, React, SwiftUI, Figma, Paper, Framer, Adobe Creative Cloud, HTML/CSS, Three.js, WebGL